

A MIX OF DIGITAL & REAL

The innovation-led company is betting on digital-first employee initiatives, while not discounting the power of physical interactions

By **Perna Lidhoo**



Key HR initiatives

- Global time-off benefit for employees affected by Covid-19, in addition to regional time-off benefits
- Flexible work schedules and two paid, week-long company holidays each year
- Employee assistance programme offers 24x7 confidential counselling, access to well-being apps for free and yearly wellness reimbursement of \$600
- As part of D&I it has achieved 100% pay parity globally; partnered with entities teaching computer science skills to girls; evolved recruiting practices to mitigate bias; introduced supplier diversity programme

▶ **IN SEPTEMBER 2021**, Adobe India appointed IBM veteran Prativa Mohapatra as its new Vice President and Managing Director. The global tech giant's first woman leader in the country, its employees say, will inspire other female employees to take up leadership positions. "Gender in India happens to be one of the biggest markers of inclusion but for us it's a business initiative and not so much of an HR initiative. We have a global goal of increasing women in leadership positions to 30 per cent by 2025 and India is well on track towards it," says Abdul Jaleel, Vice President, Employee Experience, Adobe India.

Diversity and inclusion are not the only company philosophies that Jaleel—who has been with Adobe India for over 13 years—swears by. He believes that physical collaboration leads to better problem solving; but when the pandemic made that next to impossible, the company's biggest challenge was 'change'. "There's value in coming together because we believe innovation is a social process. It was more of a mindset shift and like growing a new skin and adapting to newer behaviours without affecting work," he explains.

During the pandemic, Adobe India doubled down on its HR initiatives and best practices to help its employees cope with it better. It has introduced a time-off benefit for employees directly impacted by Covid-19, either because they are ill, caring for a family member who is ill or have to take care of a child or elder. In addition, Adobe offers two paid week-long company holidays each year, one in summer and one in winter. Jaleel explains that along with physical well-being, emotional and mental well-being is also a prime focus for the organisation. Adobe's employee assistance programme offers all employees 24x7 access to confidential counselling in addition to meditation and well-being applications like Headspace and LifeDojo being made available for free. The company also has an annual wellness reimbursement programme, which was increased to \$600 and expanded the scope of items covered to include online learning tools, extra-curricular activities, books, activity kits and art supplies to help parents with childcare and remote learning.

"The only asset we have is our employees. We invested disproportionately with regard to ensuring that they are safe, healthy and making sure we had a mechanism to be in touch with them. We ensured that the employees are aware that the leadership team is there to help them in seeing through this challenging period. I would probably rate our employee communication as 10/10," Jaleel says.

Adobe's India offices house around 7,000 employees and have the largest employee concentration after the